

GUIDE TO PERSONAL STATEMENT

What is a personal statement?

A personal statement is a short testimonial, composed by you, which provides us with more information about you than just a list of your qualifications and work experience.

How long should my personal statement be?

A page or two A4 pages in standard font.

What should I say in my personal statement?

Your personal statement is personal to you and intended to reflect your own situation. However, there in this section you should address the following questions and areas;

- a) Why do you want to study in the UK rather than any other country?*
- b) Why does this subject and course interest you?*
- c) Why do you think X University is the best place for your studies, as opposed to other institutions? Did you consider any other courses or institutions? (NB: IF you are considering other universities then you MUST write different personal statements)*
- d) What will you do when you finish this course and how will the course support your future plans?*
- e) What was your most previous qualification, where did you study it and what have you been doing since you finished it?*

Why are you the right person for this course?

This is your chance to demonstrate that you would be a suitable and good student for the course. For example, if you have applied to study Business Management, tell us how studying this subject will benefit you in the future, what career you are interested in, and why business interests you.

Also in this section, you could tell us about your academic studies, your interests outside of school/college, any relevant work experience, and any other information that you think might be helpful in showing us that you are a committed and knowledgeable student.

How will you contribute to this course and to student life?

In this section, you could tell us what makes you an interesting and unique person? You might want to include some of the below points:

- a) How do you stand out from other people?*
- b) What do you do for fun?*
- c) Responsibilities you hold, for example in any sports, societies or after school activities*
- d) Any special achievements that you are proud of*

Tips on Writing Personal Statements: Do's and Don'ts

There are several ways to write a personal statement. Again, it is up to you, But remember:

Do...

- Do keep your sentences clear and concise and come straight to the point. For example, when answering the question, 'Why do you want to study this subject?' you could begin your sentence with, 'I would like to study this subject because...'
- Do your research in advance
- Do use a spellchecker, but remember that it doesn't work in all cases
- Do draft and re-draft your statement, and get someone else to check it before you send it
- Do be original and express yourself. Let your personality shine through
- Talk about any extracurricular activities you are taking – this is your opportunity to demonstrate your interests

Do not...

- Do not use automatic translation software.
- Do not make errors of fact. For example, 'Nottingham University is in London' is not correct. Make sure you know that what you say is true and accurate
- Do not use I frequently
- Do not introduce yourself by stating your name, age and nationality (this is something that the university will know through your application form as you state your personal details)